FAMILY DEVOTIONS FOR THE WEEK

Faith Formation for Families • The Congregation at Prayer • Week of October 11–17, 2026

Season of Pentecost ✠ Liturgical Color: Green

Invocation
In the name of the Father and of the ✠ Son and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.

Introit (see back page)

Memory Verse for the Week — 1 Timothy 1:15
"The saying is trustworthy and deserving of full acceptance, that Christ Jesus came into the world to save sinners, of whom I am the foremost."

Daily Readings: LSB p. 299

Sun: Deuteronomy 9:23—10:22; Matthew 11:20–30
Mon: Deuteronomy 11:1–25; Matthew 12:1–21
Tue: Deuteronomy 11:26—12:12; Matthew 12:22–37
Wed: Deuteronomy 12:13–32; Matthew 12:38–50
Thu: Deuteronomy 13:1–18; Matthew 13:1–23
Fri: Deuteronomy 14:1–2, 22–23, 14:28—15:15; Matthew 13:24–43
Sat: Deuteronomy 15:19—16:22; Matthew 13:44–58

Talk About It This Week
Each day, read the appointed readings (or just one), then ask: *Where did we hear God's Word planted today? What is God teaching us to trust?* Day-by-day questions for younger and older children are in the daily devotion pages (and on the web page).

In Our Prayers This Week (LSB Daily Prayer Themes)
✠ **Sun:** the joy of the resurrection; fruit of faith in all who heard the Word today
✠ **Mon:** our Baptism, callings, and daily work; schools; good government and peace
✠ **Tues:** deliverance from temptation and evil; the addicted and despairing
✠ **Wed:** marriage and family; parents and children; our home and community
✠ **Thurs:** the Church, pastors, teachers, and missionaries; thanksgiving for the Sacrament
✠ **Fri:** the preaching of the cross; the persecuted; the sick and the dying
✠ **Sat:** faithfulness to the end; hearts made ready for the Lord's Day

Hymn of the Week: "Soul, Adorn Yourself with Gladness" — LSB 636
Soul, adorn yourself with gladness, / Leave the gloomy haunts of sadness, / Come into the daylight's splendor, / There with joy your praises render. / Bless the One whose grace unbounded / This amazing banquet founded.

Apostles' Creed

Lord's Prayer

Benediction
Let us bless the Lord. **Thanks be to God.**

HOW TO USE THIS PAGE… Gather once a day — at breakfast, supper, or bedtime. Speak the Invocation, say the memory verse together, read the day's readings, talk about them, sing the hymn stanza, pray for the day's theme, and close with the Lord's Prayer and Benediction. Ten minutes is plenty. The seed does the work — "so shall My word be… it shall not return to Me empty" (Isaiah 55:11).

The Twentieth Sunday after Pentecost (Proper 23) October 11, 2026

Season of Pentecost ✠ Liturgical Color: Green

Introit *Isaiah 61:10; antiphon: Psalm 146:2*

I will praise the LORD as long as I live;
I will sing praises to my God while I have my being.
I will greatly rejoice in the LORD;
my soul shall exult in my God,
for he has clothed me with the garments of salvation;
he has covered me with the robe of righteousness,
as a bridegroom decks himself like a priest with a beautiful headdress,
and as a bride adorns herself with her jewels.
Glory be to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit;
as it was in the beginning, is now, and will be forever. Amen.
I will praise the LORD as long as I live;
I will sing praises to my God while I have my being.

Collect of the Day

Merciful Father, in Your mercy You have visited us with Your Son that we might know the joy of His salvation. Grant that this joy we know in Christ may be with us in every circumstance and be fulfilled in us when we are delivered through death into everlasting life; through Jesus Christ, Your Son, our Lord, who lives and reigns with You and the Holy Spirit, one God, now and forever. Amen.

This Sunday's Readings

Isaiah 25:6–9 · Psalm 23 · Philippians 4:4–13 · Matthew 22:1–14

Gradual *Psalm 91:11; 103:1*

For he will command his angels concerning you
to guard you in all your ways.
Bless the LORD, O my soul,
and all that is within me, bless his holy name!

Next Sunday's Readings (Proper 24)

Isaiah 45:1–7 · Psalm 96:1–9 (10–13) · 1 Thessalonians 1:1–10 · Matthew 22:15–22

Learn by Heart: Holy Baptism — What does such baptizing with water indicate? *LSB p. 325*

"It indicates that the Old Adam in us should by daily contrition and repentance be drowned and die with all sins and evil desires, and that a new man should daily emerge and arise to live before God in righteousness and purity forever."

THIS WEEK AT HOME: A king throws a wedding feast and the invited guests will not come — some are busy, some are hostile. So he sends his servants to the streets to bring in everyone they find, good and bad alike, until the hall is full. Isaiah promises this Sunday that God will spread a feast for all peoples and swallow up death forever. Notice that the one man without a wedding garment had no excuse: the host supplied them. Ask one another: "What keeps us from the feast — being too busy, or thinking we should dress ourselves?"

Kids in the Divine Service — What is the "Sanctus"?

The Sanctus (pronounced sahnk-TOOS) is a hymn of praise sung during Holy Communion. "Sanctus" is Latin for "holy." It begins, "Holy, holy, holy Lord God of Sabaoth; heaven and earth are full of Your glory" — the very words the angels sing in Isaiah 6 — and then, "Blessed is He who comes in the name of the Lord," the words the crowds sang on Palm Sunday.

The Sanctus proclaims that Jesus comes to be with us in His body and blood for the forgiveness of sins. When we sing it, the angels in heaven and all who have died in the faith join us. This week's Gospel is about a wedding feast — and at the Sanctus you are standing right at the door of it.

Parents: *Encourage your children to sing the Sanctus with the congregation. Remind them that Jesus is really here, and that they are singing with people and heavenly beings they cannot even see.*

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